

Antonio Carmagnani

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Dear Hiring Team at the Mærsk Mc-Kinney Møller Center,

I trained as an architect, and what progressively drew me beyond the drawings were the questions a design studio rarely stops on - why something is being built, whether it should be built there at all, and what its impact will be over its life. Following those questions took me to a Master's Degree in Architecture Computation at The Royal Danish Academy and, within it, specifically toward data, which is the part that makes it possible to answer them with evidence instead of intuition, and from there into sustainability and responsible business consulting. Working from evidence rather than intuition is what the Center does institutionally, since the analyses its Regulation and Policy Hub publishes are what governments, regulators and industry argue over when the rules for shipping are written.

At Sweco I supported advisory teams delivering water, energy and transport projects financed by development banks including the World Bank, EBRD, KfW and EIB, and authored climate risk assessments for major water supply projects under JASPERS and EBRD climate-proofing guidance, screening hazards against projection data and rating exposure and vulnerability asset by asset. Working to lender standards taught me that an assessment is only useful if it survives review by someone with money at stake, which changes how you evidence every claim you make. This role puts that same requirement in front of a harder audience, because a policy assessment that reaches an IMO submission has to hold up for negotiators whose job is to find the weak assumption in it.

My Master's Degree in Architecture Computation gave the analytical side of my work its proper depth. I built a predictive property valuation model using ensemble learning across XGBoost, LightGBM, Ridge and CatBoost that finished in the top two per cent of its competition, and a machine learning tool that generates site-specific development recommendations for buildings in Copenhagen by combining financial, social, sustainability and geospatial data, with an interface that lets non-technical stakeholders adjust the impact drivers and weightings themselves. The second of those mattered more to me than the first, because it forced the modelling to survive contact with people who would never open the code. Working with Navigate to model regulatory designs, fuel cost assumptions and scenarios asks for the same discipline, which is models whose assumptions can be stated plainly to the people who have to act on them.

The Center is an independent not-for-profit whose analyses are used by governments and industry to design the regulatory framework for shipping's energy transition, which is an unusual place from which to do quantitative work. That is where I want to keep building sustainability work that is measurable, backed by evidence, and able to withstand scrutiny.

Best,

Antonio Carmagnani